CROSS-BORDER NOTES

A bank compliance team in Amman cut me off halfway through my climate data pitch.

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They didn't want the impact story. They wanted to know if this would get them closer to their green lending quota before the deadline.

The buyer is never the sustainability team. Sustainability teams write the narrative. They don't sign the purchase order.

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Compliance teams own the quota. Missing it triggers a regulatory penalty, not a bad headline.

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Local banks buy climate data because the cost of non-compliance is priced and dated. Goodwill is not.

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Underwriting frontier market climate exposure? Read the mandate, not the ESG deck. Who owns the compliance quota, and by when?

Sun Choi
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